

Liyi Zhou

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CS Lecturer (~US Assistant Professor) @ The University of Sydney

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

AI4SEC

AI4Sec Security **EvoHunt: Transferable Self-Evolving Playbooks for Agentic Security Auditing** *arXiv'26*

Z Wang, C W M Ng, C Yu, S Sheng, K Qin, [L Zhou](#).

Core A AI4Sec Security **AI Agent Smart Contract Exploit Generation** *FC'26*

A Gervais, [L Zhou](#)

AI4Sec Security **Agentic Discovery and Validation of Android App Vulnerabilities**

Ziyue Wang, [L Zhou](#)

BLOCKCHAIN

Core A* Security **High-Frequency Trading on Decentralized On-Chain Exchanges** *IEEE SP'21*

[L Zhou](#), K Qin, C Torres, D Le, A Gervais.

Core A* Security **On the Just-In-Time Discovery of Profit-Generating Transactions in DeFi Protocols** *IEEE SP'21*

[L Zhou](#), K Qin, A Cully, B Livshits, A Gervais.

Core A* Security **Quantifying Blockchain Extractable Value: How dark is the forest?** *IEEE SP'22*

K Qin, [L Zhou](#), A Gervais.

Core A* Security Privacy **SoK: Decentralized Finance (DeFi) Attacks** *IEEE SP'23*

[L Zhou](#), X Xiong, J Ernstberger, S Chaliasos, Z Wang, Y Wang, K Qin, R Wattenhofer, D Song, A Gervais

Core A* Security **Blockchain Amplification Attack** *Sigmetrics '25*

T Tsuchiya, [L Zhou](#), K Qin, A Gervais, N Christin

Core A* Security **Speculative Denial-of-Service Attacks in Ethereum** *USENIX Security'24*

A Yaish, K Qin, [L Zhou](#), Aviv Zohar, A Gervais.

Core A* Security **The Blockchain Imitation Game** *USENIX Security'23*

K Qin, S Chaliasos, [L Zhou](#), B Livshits, D Song, A Gervais.

Core A* Privacy **On How Zero-Knowledge Proof Blockchain Mixers Improve, and Worsen User Privacy** *WWW'23*

Z Wang, S Chaliasos, K Qin, [L Zhou](#), L Gao, P Berrang, B Livshits, A Gervais

Core A* Security **Smart Contract and Defi Security Tools: Do They Meet the Needs of Practitioners?** *ICSE'24*

S Chaliasos, M Charalambous, [L Zhou](#), R Galanopoulou, A Gervais, D Mitropoulos, B Livshits.

TEACHING

INFO5995: Introduction to Cybersecurity @ The University of Sydney

2026 Semester 1

INFO2222: Computing 2 Usability and Security @ The University of Sydney

2025 Semester 1

SERVICES

Program Committee Co-Chair

ACM CCS Workshop on Decentralized Finance and Security

2024, 2025

Program Committee

Core A* Usenix Security	2026
Core A* The ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security (CCS)	2025, 2026
Core A Financial Cryptography and Data Security (FC)	2024, 2025, 2026
The Science of Blockchain (Stanford)	2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
The Latest in DeFi Research (TL;DR)	2024, 2025
CESC Crypto Economics Security Conference (UC Berkeley)	2022
ACM CCS Workshop on Decentralized Finance and Security	2021, 2022, 2023

Invited Reviewer

Transactions on Information Forensics & Security	2023
Financial Innovation	2021, 2022, 2023, 2024
Transactions on Dependable and Secure Computing	2023

External Reviewer

Core A* IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy	2023
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AWARDS AND GRANTS

ARC DECRA Fellowship , 527,178 AUD, Advancing AI for Software Exploit Generation	<i>Ongoing, 2026</i>
Sui Academic Research Awards , 25k USD	<i>Awarded, 2025</i>
Innosuisse Start-Up Innovation , 703k CHF, AI-Enhanced Smart Contract Auditing	<i>Completed, 2024</i>
Ethereum Academic Grant 2024 , 55k USD, Training an EVM-native GPT	<i>Completed, 2024</i>
Ethereum Academic Grant 2023 , 72k USD, Blockchain Censorship DoS	<i>Completed, 2023</i>
Ethereum Academic Grant 2023 , 25k USD, Blockchain Censorship Measurement	<i>Completed, 2023</i>

EDUCATION

PhD in Computer Science	Imperial College London, United Kingdom <i>Oct 2019 – Feb 2025</i>
MRes in Web Science and Big Data Analytics	University College London, United Kingdom <i>Oct 2017 – Sep 2018</i>
MSci & ARCS in Maths and Computer Science	Imperial College London, United Kingdom <i>Oct 2010 – Sep 2014</i>

OTHER EXPERIENCES

Former Co-founder, Decentralized Intelligence AG (D23E)	2022–2026
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